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THE NAME CHANGE PLAYBOOK

2026-27 EDITION

Fix one name across every record — in the right order, once.

Aadhaar · PAN · Passport · Voter ID · Driving Licence · Bank · EPF · Degrees · Gazette

Verified against UIDAI, Income Tax Department, Passport Seva, ECI, Parivahan, EPFO, CBSE and the Department of Publication on 11 November 2026

38 pages · 21 parts · 9 fill-in templates

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Read this page first

Somewhere in your file cabinet there are two versions of you. One is the name on your Class 10 marksheet — the name your school wrote when you were fifteen. The other is the name on your Aadhaar, which may be spelled differently, may carry your husband's surname, may have a middle name nobody uses, or may be a completely different name you chose as an adult.

Every office in India compares your name against a document it trusts. When the names disagree, the request simply stops. A bank account freezes pending re-KYC. A passport application is returned. A provident fund claim is rejected for a name that does not match Aadhaar. A mutual fund redemption is held. A degree certificate cannot be corrected. None of this is a legal problem — it is a sequencing problem, and it is fixable in a few weeks if you do the documents in the right order and unfixable in years if you do them in the wrong one.

This playbook is that order. It covers the rules as they stand in November 2026, including the biggest change in years: UIDAI's revised name-update procedure, issued by circular on 18 September 2026, which replaced the 2021 process and split name changes into minor changes, data-entry errors, marriage and divorce changes, and major changes that need a Gazette notification.

> **What this playbook is not**
>
> It is not a substitute for legal advice on a disputed name, a court case, or a property title. It is also not a pitch for an agent. Every step here is something you can do yourself on a phone or with one counter visit. Where a fee varies by state or by portal, the book says so instead of inventing a number.

How to use it in five minutes

1. Turn to Part 3 and find your case among the eight scenarios. Two minutes.
2. Read Part 1 — the source-of-truth rule. It decides which document you fix first, and it is the single biggest time-saver in the book.
3. If you are a woman changing a surname after marriage, go straight to Part 5 (Aadhaar) and then Part 6 (PAN). You probably do not need the Gazette at all.
4. If you are changing your full name, or your first name, read Part 2 and then Part 12 (the Gazette route) before you pay anyone anything.
5. Print Part 21, the master checklist, and tick it as you go.

The three words that decide your case

Term	What it means in 2026	What it costs you
Minor change	Same person, same identity: expanding initials, adding or dropping a middle name or surname, reordering names, or a spelling fix that sounds the same (Ram to Rama, Somya to Saumya).	Aadhaar update with a valid Proof of Identity. No Gazette, no newspaper.

Term	What it means in 2026	What it costs you
Data-entry error	The name was recorded wrongly in Aadhaar even though the document you submitted at enrolment was correct.	One affidavit in UIDAI's Annexure B format plus a Proof of Identity.
Major change	A complete change of name, or any change that amounts to a change of identity.	A Gazette notification is mandatory. Then every other record follows it.

Most people who believe they need a Gazette notification do not need one. Most people who need one try to skip it and waste three months. Part 2 tells the difference in a single table.

The honesty note on fees and timelines

Every government fee in this book was checked in November 2026 against the issuing department's own page, rate order or portal. Government fees change without announcement, and state-level charges vary. Where a figure can move, the book marks it as "check at payment" and tells you where on the screen it appears. Nothing in this book is a quotation from a middleman.

PART 1

The source-of-truth rule

Why the order matters more than the paperwork

Here is the mistake that costs people months. They walk into an Aadhaar Seva Kendra and change their name to what they want it to be. The operator updates it. Three weeks later they apply for a passport, and the passport office asks for proof of the change — a Gazette notification, or newspaper clippings, or a marriage certificate. They have none, because they changed the destination without building the bridge.

A name change is not one event. It is a chain of evidence, and every office in India asks the same question in a different accent: show me a document that already carries this name, issued by somebody more official than you. Your own declaration proves nothing. A government record proves everything.

> **The rule, in one line**
>
> Find the document that is allowed to create the new name. Change that one first. Then change everything else by pointing at it.

Which document is allowed to create the name?

There are only four answers, and your reason for changing the name decides which one applies.

Your reason	The document that creates the new name	What it unlocks
Marriage — you are taking your husband's surname, or adding his name	The marriage certificate from the Registrar of Marriages (or, for a passport surname change only, a joint declaration in Annexure J)	Aadhaar, PAN, passport, voter ID, driving licence, bank, EPF, degrees — most offices accept it directly.

Your reason	The document that creates the new name	What it unlocks
Divorce or death of spouse — you are reverting to your maiden name	The divorce decree, or the death certificate plus your old records	Aadhaar (with an Annexure D affidavit), PAN, passport, bank.
A spelling mistake or a variation that sounds the same	The earliest correct record — usually the school leaving certificate, Class 10 marksheet, birth certificate or passport	Aadhaar as a minor change, then PAN, then the rest. No Gazette.
A genuinely new name — a different first name, or a full change	The Gazette of India, Part IV (or your State Gazette, where the receiving office asks for it)	Everything. Without it, Aadhaar will reject a major change and the passport office will not accept a major change.

The order, in one picture

Aadhaar sits at the bottom because almost every other system now reads from it: PAN linking, bank KYC, CKYC, EPF, SIM re-verification, subsidy transfer. PAN sits next to it because Section 139AA of the old Income-tax Act — carried into the Income-tax Act, 2025 — requires the name on PAN to match Aadhaar. Fix those two and half the country stops arguing with you.

Step	Record	Why it sits here
1	The creating document (marriage certificate, Gazette, or your earliest correct school record)	Nothing downstream can be fixed without it.
2	Aadhaar	The base identity record. PAN linking, bank KYC, EPF and DBT all read it.
3	PAN	Must match Aadhaar. A mismatch blocks linking and freezes refunds.
4	Passport	The strongest photo ID you own. Once corrected, it becomes proof for everything else.
5	Voter ID and driving licence	Both accept the documents you already hold by now, so they become easy.
6	Bank, credit card, demat, mutual funds, insurer, SIM	These are copies. They update from the records above, usually with one form.
7	EPF / UAN, employer payroll	Needs Aadhaar plus supporting proof, and a signature from your employer.
8	Degrees, board certificates, ration card, property records	The slowest and most discretionary. Start them last, and start them early in the year.

> **The one thing never to do**
>
> Do not update Aadhaar to a new name before the creating document exists. UIDAI now verifies the genuineness of the Proof of Identity, the affidavit and any Gazette notification before processing a name change. A name you typed yourself, with no document behind it, will be rejected — and a rejected update sits in the system while you sort it out.

How long this actually takes

If your case is a marriage surname change, the realistic end-to-end window is three to five weeks, most of it waiting for Aadhaar and PAN to reissue. A spelling correction is faster: Aadhaar updates in about a week to ten days, PAN reissues in roughly a fortnight after verification, and the rest follow. A major name change through the Gazette is the slow one: the Department of Publication's own guidance gives no guaranteed date, and applicants commonly report 30 to 60 days between submission and publication, before you even start on the other records.

Which is why Part 18 gives you a 30-day calendar that runs several offices in parallel instead of one after another. The chain is a dependency order, not a queue — once Aadhaar is submitted, you can begin the passport paperwork, and once the Gazette is submitted, you can begin everything that accepts a submission receipt.

PART 2

The 18 September 2026 Aadhaar rules

The circular that changed how names are updated

On 18 September 2026, UIDAI issued a revised Standard Operating Procedure for updating the name in Aadhaar. It superseded the name-update process described in the SOP of 28 October 2021. The practical effect is that the counter no longer decides your case by feel: every request now falls into a defined category, and each category has a named document. If you arrive with the wrong document for your category, you are sent back — politely, and without an update.

UIDAI has also said, in the same circular, that it will verify the genuineness of the Proof of Identity, the Proof of Relationship, affidavits and Gazette notifications submitted in support of a name update. This is new in emphasis, and it matters: a photocopy that has been through a bad scanner, an affidavit on the wrong stamp paper, or a Gazette copy downloaded from a private website instead of the official e-Gazette portal are all reasons for rejection.

The eight categories, and the document each one needs

What you are changing	Category	Document required
Expanding an abbreviation, abbreviating to initials, adding or dropping a middle name, adding or dropping a surname, changing the order of names	Minor change	A valid Proof of Identity (PoI). For a child under 18, an applicable Proof of Relationship, or a Head of Family based update.
A small spelling correction where the name still sounds the same — Ram to Rama, Somya to Saumya	Minor change	A valid PoI.
The name was entered wrongly even though your enrolment document was correct	Data-entry error	Affidavit in Annexure B, plus a PoI (Annexure C for a minor, plus PoI or PoR). The requested name must match the correct name on a document already given to UIDAI.
A woman changing her surname after marriage or divorce	Marriage or divorce	Affidavit in Annexure D, plus a PoI. A registered marriage certificate is also accepted as supporting documentation.

What you are changing	Category	Document required
A change of name following a change of gender	Gender change	An applicable PoI.
Dropping a rank, designation or prefix (for example a military rank or "Dr")	Prefix removal	An applicable PoI.
Removing "urf" or an alias from the recorded name	Alias removal	Affidavit in Annexure E, plus a PoI (Annexure F for a minor).
A complete change of name, or anything that amounts to a change of identity	Major change	A Gazette notification for the name change, plus an applicable PoI. Without the Gazette notification, the request is liable to be rejected.

Two things you no longer need a document for

The circular lists two corrections that need no supporting document at all. Random capitalisation inside a name — "RaMesh" instead of "Ramesh" — can be corrected without paperwork. So can the removal of dots from a name. If your Aadhaar reads "A. P. J. Abdul Kalam" style with full stops, that is a free, document-free fix, and it is worth doing at the same visit as anything else.

> **The rule that catches everybody**
>
> The name will be updated to match the spelling, sequence and abbreviation used in the document you submit. Not to what you write on the form. If your marriage certificate says "Sunita Rani" and you want "Sunita Rani Sharma", the certificate has to say Sharma, or you need the Gazette. Aadhaar will not add a surname that your proof does not carry.

What counts as a Proof of Identity now

UIDAI's acceptable-documents list was refreshed in October 2026. For a name update, the useful entries are: passport; PAN card or e-PAN; voter ID or e-voter ID; driving licence; ration or PDS photo card; a photo identity card issued by a Central, State or UT government, a PSU or a bank; a pensioner photo card; a Kisan photo passbook; a CGHS, ECHS, ESIC or Ayushman-style health card with photo; a disability ID card; a marriage certificate with photograph issued by a State or Central government; a school leaving certificate, transfer certificate, SSLC book or board marksheet containing name and photograph; and a bank passbook with name and photograph, cross-stamped by a bank official.

Three entries deserve emphasis because they are the ones people forget. A marriage certificate with a photograph is a PoI in its own right. A school leaving certificate or board marksheet with your photograph is a PoI — which means that for most spelling corrections, the document you already have in a drawer is enough. And the Gazette notification of a new name is accepted for a full name or first name change, as proof of identity only: it cannot be used to prove address, relationship or date of birth.

What has not changed

The channels and the fees are the same as before. You can place a name update at any Aadhaar Enrolment Centre or Aadhaar Seva Kendra; UIDAI-run Seva Kendras take appointments through bookappointment.uidai.gov.in, are free to book, and are open all seven days from 9:30 am to 5:30 pm. A limited name update can also be placed online through the myAadhaar self-service update route, with a valid proof, if your mobile number is registered. And the fee structure is unchanged: a demographic update costs ₹75 when done separately, biometrics cost ₹125, and a demographic update done at the same time as a biometric update is free. A document update at a centre is ₹75.

One visit, several fixes

The fee is per transaction, not per field. If your name needs a spelling fix and your address is five years old and your photograph predates your wedding, do all of it in one appointment. The demographic fee stays ₹75 whether you change one field or four.

PART 3

Find your case

Eight scenarios, and what each one actually needs

Read the row that sounds like you. The part numbers tell you where to go. If two rows apply — a spelling fix and a surname change, for example — follow the heavier one; the lighter fix can ride along in the same Aadhaar transaction.

#	Your situation	What it needs	Go to
1	Married, taking your husband's surname or adding his name	Marriage certificate (or Annexure J for the passport only). No Gazette.	Parts 5, 6, 7, 8
2	Married, but only the spelling of your name is wrong on some records	Your school leaving certificate or board marksheet. No marriage certificate needed for the spelling fix.	Parts 5, 6
3	Divorced or widowed, reverting to your maiden name	Divorce decree or death certificate, plus an Annexure D affidavit for Aadhaar.	Parts 5, 6, 7
4	Your Aadhaar name is wrong because the operator typed it wrongly	Annexure B affidavit plus a PoI that carries the correct name.	Part 5
5	You use initials, and every office expands them differently	A PoI that shows the expanded form. Minor change, no Gazette.	Parts 5, 6, 7
6	You have one name only, no surname	Depends on the receiving office: passport needs a surname field, banks vary. Read the case note in Part 7 before you decide.	Part 7
7	You are adopting a genuinely new name as an adult	Gazette notification first. Then everything else.	Parts 2, 12
8	Your child's name is wrong on school and Aadhaar records	Annexure C affidavit plus PoI or PoR. Head of Family route for children under 18.	Parts 5, 11

Case notes worth reading even if you skipped the table

Case 1 is the most common and the least understood. A woman who marries and takes her husband's surname does not need a Gazette notification, does not need a newspaper advertisement, and does not need a notarised affidavit for her passport. She needs a marriage certificate — and if she does not have one, she can register the marriage, which is cheaper and faster than the Gazette route by an order of magnitude. Part 13 covers registration. The passport route accepts a joint declaration in Annexure J in place of a marriage certificate, but Aadhaar does not, and PAN prefers the certificate.

Case 5 — initials — is where quiet rejections happen. If your Aadhaar reads "K. R. Narayanan" and your degree reads "Kocheril Raman Narayanan", that is a minor change and an expanded PoI is enough. But if you submit a document that itself uses initials, Aadhaar will keep the initials. The document decides the spelling, so choose the document that says what you want.

Case 6 — the single-name problem — is genuinely awkward and deserves honesty rather than a template. Indian passport forms expect a given name and a surname. Applicants with one name usually resolve it either by expanding the name into a form the form accepts, or by recording the same name in both fields after checking with the Passport Seva Kendra, or by going through a formal change. Do not guess: ask at the PSK counter or on the passport helpline before you file, because a rejected application costs you the fee and a fresh appointment.

Case 8 is where parents lose the most time. A child's Aadhaar name can be updated using a Head of Family based route with a Proof of Relationship, and the school record is usually the document that needs fixing first, because the school record is what the board certificate will eventually say. Fix the school register entry while your child is still enrolled. Once the board certificate is printed, Part 11 applies, and Part 11 is the least forgiving part of this book.

The two-minute self-audit

Before you spend a rupee, write these seven fields on one sheet of paper, exactly as they appear, from each of the documents below. Put them side by side. The column with the odd one out is your problem, and the pattern of differences tells you the category.

Field	Where to look	What people get wrong
Full name, exactly as printed	Aadhaar, PAN, passport, voter ID, driving licence, bank passbook, degree	Comparing a scanned copy with a card instead of the original. Scan artefacts create imaginary differences.
Expansion of initials	Class 10 marksheet, school leaving certificate	Assuming the board expanded the initials. Often it did not.
Father's or husband's name	Aadhaar, PAN, passport	The relation field is a separate change with its own proof. Do not assume it rides along.
Date of birth	Aadhaar, PAN, passport, board certificate	Changing DOB is a one-time, heavily scrutinised change. Never bundle it casually.
Gender	Aadhaar, PAN, voter ID	One change only, with its own document requirement.
Address	Aadhaar, bank, voter ID	An address mismatch does not block a name change, but it does block KYC.
Signature	Bank, PAN, passport	A signature that has drifted is a separate correction, not a name problem.

If the audit shows four or more differences

Do not start with the record you use most. Start with the creating document in Part 1, even if that takes longer. Four mismatches usually mean the records were built at different times from different papers, and only the creating document can align all of them.

PART 4

The master sequence

The dependency map, and what runs in parallel

This part is the whole book in two pages. Everything after it is detail.

The chain

Your creating document is the root. Aadhaar is the trunk. Everything else branches from Aadhaar, and a few branches depend on each other: the passport needs PAN as a supporting identity document, the bank needs both, the EPF record needs Aadhaar to be final, and the degree correction needs a Gazette or a court order that predates the result.

Stage	What you are waiting for	What you can start while waiting
Stage 0	The creating document: marriage certificate, Gazette notification, or your earliest correct school record	Collect photocopies of every record you own. Fill in the two-minute audit in Part 3. Book the Aadhaar appointment.
Stage 1	Aadhaar update submitted (about a week to ten days to reflect)	Draft the PAN CR-01 application. Assemble passport documents. Do not submit PAN until Aadhaar shows the new name.
Stage 2	Aadhaar updated	File PAN CR-01 with Aadhaar e-KYC. Begin the passport re-issue application online; take the appointment slot.
Stage 3	PAN updated (e-PAN in 48 to 72 hours after verification, card in about two weeks)	File voter ID Form 8 and the driving licence change on Sarathi. Both accept Aadhaar and PAN.
Stage 4	Passport re-issued	Bank re-KYC, credit card, demat, mutual fund KYC, insurer endorsement, SIM re-verification. These are all one-form jobs now.
Stage 5	Bank and CKYC updated	EPF joint declaration through your employer. Payroll master update.
Stage 6	Everything above is consistent	Degrees, board certificates, ration card, property records. Expect discretion, delay, and a fee per document.

The parallel rule

You are never blocked on a receipt. Once you have submitted the Aadhaar update, you hold an acknowledgement number — and most offices will accept a printout of it alongside your old record while the update processes. Ask at the counter, note who told you, and keep the acknowledgement with the file.

Four things that must never travel together

1. Date of birth and name in one Aadhaar transaction, when the date of birth is also wrong. Fix the name first; the date of birth change is scrutinised separately and a bundled request invites a query on both.
2. A major name change and a marriage surname change. If you are taking a new first name as well as a new surname, the whole thing is a major change and needs the Gazette. Splitting it into two requests does not make it minor — it makes it two rejections.
3. A passport application and an unfixed PAN. The passport office will ask for identity documents, and a PAN that disagrees with your Aadhaar invites a query you cannot answer at the counter.
4. A degree correction and a pending Gazette. CBSE's rule requires the change to be notified in the Gazette before the result is published, and a Gazette obtained afterwards does not meet it. Read Part 11 before you spend money on a university application.

PART 5

Aadhaar

The base record, and the cheapest fix in the chain

Which channel to use

Channel	Use it when	What it costs
myAadhaar self-service update (SSUP) online	You are making a minor name change with a valid PoI, your mobile number is registered, and you can scan a clean document	₹75 per demographic update request
Aadhaar Seva Kendra, with an appointment	Name change of any category, or any change where the document is unusual. Best for marriage and divorce cases.	₹75 demographic; ₹125 biometric; free if the demographic update is done with a biometric update
Bank, post office or state-run Aadhaar Kendra	You cannot get an ASK slot. Service quality varies; carry every original.	Same UIDAI fee, collected by the registrar

Appointments at UIDAI-run Seva Kendras are booked at bookappointment.uidai.gov.in, are free to book, do not need a registered mobile number, and are capped at two per person per month. The centres are open all seven days, 9:30 am to 5:30 pm. Book in the morning of the day you plan to visit — slots for the same week open up constantly as people cancel.

What to carry for a name update

- ☐ Original Aadhaar and a photocopy
- ☐ The creating document, original plus photocopy — marriage certificate with photograph, Gazette notification, school leaving certificate, or board marksheet
- ☐ The affidavit in the correct Annexure, if your category needs one — B for a data-entry error, C for a minor's data-entry error, D for a surname change after marriage or divorce, E or F for alias removal

- ☐ A second PoI, ideally a passport or PAN, because a single document that is itself in doubt stalls the whole request
- ☐ Proof of address if the address is also being updated
- ☐ The acknowledgement from any earlier update, if the record has been changed before

> **The Annexure trap**
>
> UIDAI's annexures are prescribed forms, not suggestions. An affidavit drafted by a local notary in his own format, however impressive the stamp paper, is not an Annexure D. Download the current annexure, fill it, and have it attested as the annexure requires. If your Aadhaar Kendra insists on a different format, ask for the requirement in writing before you pay for another stamp paper.

What happens after you submit

You receive an update request number (URN). The update usually reflects in one to two weeks; the URN lets you check status on the UIDAI site or in the mAadhaar app. Download a fresh e-Aadhaar once it reflects — the older PDF is not evidence of the new name, and banks will notice the difference. If the request is rejected, the rejection reason is shown against the URN; the three most common are a document that does not carry the requested spelling, a photograph that does not match, and an annexure that is not in the prescribed format.

> **Free document update window**
>
> UIDAI has kept document updates (submitting a PoI or PoA) through the myAadhaar portal free until 14 June 2027. If your Aadhaar has an old address or an old proof on file, upload the current one while it is free. It is not a name change, but it removes a second reason for a bank to query you.

PART 6

PAN

One form, one checkbox, and the mistake that causes most rejections

Since 1 April 2026, PAN corrections are filed on the new forms issued under the Income-tax Act, 2025: Form PAN CR-01 for individuals and Form PAN CR-02 for companies, firms, LLPs and trusts. The old combined "Request for New PAN Card or/and Changes or Correction in PAN Data" form is gone for paper filings. Online, the portal serves you the current form, so the form name only matters if you are posting a physical application.

Where to file

Portal	Notes
Protean eGov Technologies (formerly NSDL e-Governance) — the PAN services portal linked from the Income Tax Department's services page	The default route. Token number issued at the start saves a half-filled form. Aadhaar e-KYC with OTP means nothing is posted.

Portal	Notes
UTIITSL — pan.utiitsl.com	The alternative. Useful when the Protean portal is slow, or when you already hold a UTIITSL acknowledgement.

The four steps that matter

1. Choose "Changes or Correction in existing PAN Data" and your applicant category. Note the token number Protean emails you — it lets you resume a half-finished form.
2. Tick the checkbox beside each field you want changed, and only those. This is where most rejections begin: a field where you typed a new value but did not tick the box is not updated, and the application is returned as a mismatch.
3. Choose your submission mode. Paperless with Aadhaar e-KYC and e-Sign is the easiest — your Aadhaar demographic data is used directly and nothing is printed or posted. Physical mode means posting the signed acknowledgement and proof to the Pune office within 15 days.
4. Upload the proof for every ticked field, pay, and keep the 15-digit acknowledgement number. The e-PAN usually arrives by email within 48 to 72 hours of verification; a reprinted card takes about two weeks to an Indian address.

The fee table

What you are ordering	Fee, inclusive of taxes
Correction with a physical PAN card, dispatch within India (physical submission)	₹107
Correction with a physical PAN card, dispatch within India (paperless submission)	₹101
Correction with e-PAN only, sent to your email (physical submission)	₹72
Correction with e-PAN only, sent to your email (paperless submission)	₹66
Dispatch outside India	₹1,017 (physical card) or ₹1,011 (paperless)

The fee is the same whether you correct one field or five. Fix everything in one application. Check the amount on the payment screen anyway — these figures were verified in November 2026 and the portals adjust them.

What proof does the name change need

Who you are	Documents accepted for a name change
A married woman changing her name on account of marriage	Marriage certificate, or the marriage invitation card, or a copy of the passport showing the husband's name, or publication of the name change in the official Gazette, or a certificate issued by a Gazetted officer
Any other individual	Publication of the name change in the official Gazette, or a certificate issued by a Gazetted officer (for a change in the applicant's own name only)

Who you are	Documents accepted for a name change
Company, firm, LLP, trust	ROC certificate for a company; revised partnership deed or Registrar of Firms certificate for a firm or LLP; revised deed or registration certificate for other entities

> **Aadhaar first, always**
>
> The name you ask PAN to record must be the name on your Aadhaar. If Aadhaar still carries the old name when you file the PAN correction, you are creating the exact mismatch that blocks linking later. Aadhaar, then PAN — never the other way round.

A detail people miss: the correction form requires you to give the name as per your Aadhaar. If the two genuinely differ, Rule 114(4) of the Income-tax Rules requires supporting proof of identity, address and date of birth, and the request becomes a documented case rather than a routine correction. Filing in paperless e-KYC mode is the cleanest way through, because the Aadhaar data is adopted directly.

If the correction is refused

A rejection email states the reason, and you can re-file with corrected documents at the same fee. Two rejections on the same field usually mean the underlying document is the problem, not the form: a Gazetted officer's certificate is accepted for a name change but not for a change of father's name, and an invitation card is accepted for a married woman's name change but not for a surname spelling fix. Match the document to the row in the table above and re-file once, rather than three times.

PART 7

Passport

The strongest ID you own, and the easiest to get wrong

There is no correction service for an Indian passport. You apply for a re-issue under "change in existing personal particulars", pay the re-issue fee, attend a Passport Seva Kendra, and receive a fresh booklet. The old passport is submitted in original with self-attested photocopies of its first two and last two pages, including the ECR or non-ECR page and any observation page.

Which route applies to you

Your change	Documents, besides the old passport	Tatkaal allowed?
Change of surname following marriage	Marriage certificate, or a joint photo declaration signed by both spouses in Annexure J	Not allowed
Addition of a spouse's name	Marriage certificate, or Annexure J	Not allowed
Change of name or deletion of spouse's name after divorce	Divorce order or decree; for a remarriage, the divorce decree or the first spouse's death certificate plus the new marriage certificate or Annexure J	Not allowed

Your change	Documents, besides the old passport	Tatkaal allowed?
A minor change in name — a spelling correction that does not change how the name sounds	Nothing further	Allowed
A major change in name — anything beyond a spelling fix	Clippings of two local newspapers, or the Gazette notification of the concerned State Government, plus at least two public or school documents issued in the new name	Not allowed

> **The 2016 reform still stands**
>
> The Passport Rules were amended on 23 December 2016, and since then no annexure signed by an applicant needs notarisation, stamp paper or a magistrate. Annexure J is a plain-paper joint declaration: names, dates of birth, Aadhaar or voter ID or passport numbers of both spouses, signatures of both, and a recent joint photograph self-attested by both. If an agent quotes you for notarising it, you are being sold something the rule removed.

The name-change rule, in the government's own words

> *In other circumstances for change of name, the applicant (both male and female) should furnish: clippings of two local newspapers or the Gazette notification of the concerned State Government, as the case may be; at least two public/school documents issued in the desired/applied changed name to ascertain that the applicant has actually changed his name.*

Two things follow. First, the passport rule names the State Gazette, not the Gazette of India — in practice a Gazette of India Part IV notification is normally accepted, but if your case is contentious, a State Gazette notification is the safer instrument because it matches the rule text. Second, you need two public or school documents already in the new name. The Gazette alone is not enough for a major change; it has to be followed by two documents, which is why the sequence in Part 4 puts the passport after Aadhaar and PAN.

Filing it

1. Register at passportindia.gov.in and choose "Apply for Fresh Passport / Re-issue of Passport", then Re-issue, then "Change in existing personal particulars", ticking what you are changing.
2. Fill the previous-passport section from the booklet you hold, including its file number. Get one digit wrong and the application is held.
3. Pay online and take the appointment the system offers. Attend with originals, one self-attested photocopy of each, and the old passport. No photograph is needed — it is captured at the centre.
4. Track the file with the application reference number. Police verification follows for most re-issues; keep your address proof current, because a failed verification is the most common reason a re-issue stalls.

The portal's own documents page and its FAQ have disagreed for years about whether a married applicant must produce a marriage certificate. The safe reading, and the one to act on: you are not required to prove you are married in order to hold a passport, but you are expected to evidence the change you are asking for. Carry the marriage certificate or a signed Annexure J. Arriving with neither risks a refused token and a second trip to a centre that may be in another city.

The single-name case

If your name has no surname component, the passport form's given-name and surname fields become a problem rather than a formality. There are three workable approaches, and the right one depends on what your other documents say. You can expand the name into a form the form accepts, keeping it consistent with your Aadhaar and PAN. You can record the same name in both fields, which some Passport Seva Kendras accept and others do not. Or you can formalise a change through the Gazette. Ask the helpline or the PSK counter before filing — the fee is not refundable, and a fresh appointment can be weeks away.

PART 8

Voter ID and driving licence

Two forms, one afternoon, once Aadhaar is done

Voter ID: Form 8

Name corrections on the electoral roll are filed on Form 8 — the same form used for shifting residence, replacing a lost EPIC, and marking a person with disability. On the Election Commission's Citizen Service Portal at voters.eci.gov.in, choose "Correction of Entries" and then Form 8.

The form allows a maximum of four entries to be corrected in one application: name, relation type, relation name, date of birth or age, gender, photo, address and mobile number. Every correction must be backed by a self-attested copy of a documentary proof, named on the form. Accepted proofs include Aadhaar, passport, PAN, driving licence, birth certificate, a bank or post office passbook, and utility bills for the address. A fresh passport-size colour photograph, 4.5 cm by 3.5 cm, is pasted on the form only if the photo is being changed.

- ☐ Log in to voters.eci.gov.in with your mobile number and the OTP
- ☐ Choose Correction of Entries, then Form 8, then Self
- ☐ Select "Correction of Entries in Existing Electoral Roll"
- ☐ Confirm the pre-filled state, district and constituency details
- ☐ Tick Name, type the correct spelling, and name the document you are attaching
- ☐ Upload the self-attested proof, complete the declaration, submit, and save the reference number

You will be issued a replacement EPIC when the correction is approved, and the old card is returned. Approval typically takes two to four weeks and is done by the Electoral Registration Officer for your constituency, not centrally — which is why a document that satisfies Aadhaar does not automatically satisfy the ERO. If your correction is refused, the reason is published against your reference number, and the usual fix is a clearer scan of the same document.

Driving licence: the Sarathi route

Name changes on a driving licence are filed through Parivahan's Sarathi portal, or in person at your RTO using Form 2 — the same form used for a learner's licence, a renewal, or a change of address, with a checkbox for "Change/Correction of Name in Driving Licence".

1. Go to sarathi.parivahan.gov.in, pick your state, then Driving Licence Related Services.
2. Enter your DL number and date of birth, and pull up the record.
3. Choose "Services on Driving Licence", then the change of name service, and state the reason for the change.
4. Enter the new name exactly as it should print, and the effective-from date.
5. Upload the documents the state asks for, pay the fee shown, and book an RTO slot if your state requires biometric or document verification.
6. Attend the RTO with originals. The corrected smart card arrives by post, typically in two to four weeks.

The document set most RTOs expect for a name change is: an affidavit sworn before a notary, an executive magistrate or a first-class judicial magistrate; the marriage certificate where the change is on marriage; a copy of the newspaper advertisement or the Gazette notification where the change is a formal one; the updated Aadhaar; current address proof; two passport-size photographs; and a photocopy of both sides of the existing licence. States differ on which of these they insist on, so call the RTO once, before you pay.

> **Do the licence last in this pair**
>
> A driving licence is accepted as a Proof of Identity for Aadhaar, which makes it tempting to fix first. Resist. The RTO will accept your updated Aadhaar as the document that proves the change, so the licence becomes a five-minute job once Aadhaar is done — and a difficult one if it is not.

PART 9

Bank, cards, insurance, funds and SIM

The copies that update from the records above

Everything in this part is downstream. None of it can create a new name; all of it can be updated with one form and the documents you already hold by now. Do them in one sweep, on one Saturday, and keep a photograph of every acknowledgement.

Bank account and cheque book

- ☐ Written request signed by all account holders, addressed to the branch manager
- ☐ Updated Aadhaar, updated PAN, and the creating document (marriage certificate or Gazette)
- ☐ Fresh passport photographs if the branch asks for a re-KYC form
- ☐ Nomination review — do it in the same visit, it takes two minutes and prevents a much worse problem later

- ☐ New cheque book, debit card and passbook in the new name; the old cheque book should be surrendered

Banks run a fresh KYC check rather than a simple field edit, which is why some branches insist on an in-person visit even when the app allows a name change. If your account is a joint account, every holder signs. If it is a salary account, tell your employer's payroll team on the same day — otherwise the next salary credit can bounce against a name that no longer matches the account record.

Credit cards

A credit card name change is a card reissue, not an edit. Call the issuer, state the reason, and expect a replacement card in seven to ten working days, with the old card blocked on activation of the new one. Two consequences people forget: standing instructions and auto-debits linked to the old card number need to be re-registered, and the credit bureau record is updated only after the issuer reports the change in its next monthly cycle. Check your credit report a month later.

Insurance policies

A name change on a policy is an endorsement. Send the insurer a written request with the updated Aadhaar and the creating document, and ask for an endorsement copy. Do this for health, term and motor policies separately. It matters most at claim time: an insurer can query a claimant whose policy name does not match the identity proof, and a mismatch discovered during a hospital admission is the worst possible moment to fix it.

Mutual funds, demat and CKYC

Mutual fund folios are held with a Registrar and Transfer Agent, and the name on the folio is what the RTA has recorded — not what your bank says. Most RTAs accept a name change request with the updated PAN, the updated Aadhaar, and the creating document, either through the fund's own service portal or through the RTA's investor portal. If your KYC record itself is wrong, the correction has to go through the KRA that holds your CKYC record; the fund cannot fix it for you.

For a demat account, the depository participant files the change with CDSL or NSDL. Expect to sign a fresh account modification form and to re-submit photographs. If you hold shares in physical form, the registrar for each company needs a separate request, with a signature that matches the one on the old records — a signature that has drifted is the single most common reason physical-share name changes are returned.

Mobile SIM and DBT

Telecom operators re-verify identity on a name change, and most now do it at a store rather than online. Carry the updated Aadhaar and the creating document. Do it promptly if your number is linked to Aadhaar-based authentication for banking — a SIM registered in a name that no longer matches your bank record can fail re-verification and be suspended.

For subsidy and benefit transfers — LPG, PM-Kisan, scholarships, pensions — the name on the Aadhaar is the name that matters, and the bank account must be seeded to that Aadhaar. After the bank updates, ask the branch to re-seed the Aadhaar mapping. It is a two-minute check that prevents a payment failure two months later.

PART 10

EPF and your UAN

Two documents for a minor fix, three for a major one

Your provident fund record is the one that most often disagrees with your Aadhaar, because it was created by an employer from whatever you submitted on your joining date, possibly a decade ago. The fix runs through the Joint Declaration facility on the EPFO Unified Member Portal.

The route

1. Log in to the EPFO Unified Member Portal with your UAN and password.
2. Go to Manage, then Joint Declaration. Select the relevant employer or establishment.
3. Identify the fields to correct, enter the correct values, and upload scanned supporting documents.
4. Complete Aadhaar-based OTP authentication and submit.
5. The request goes to your employer for digital verification, then to the EPFO field office. Track status on the same portal.

Since EPFO simplified member-profile correction in January 2025, a member whose UAN is validated through Aadhaar may be able to update certain profile particulars, including the name, without uploading documents. That route does not cover every case. Where the name differs substantially, where the Aadhaar record itself is not yet correct, or where the request cannot be completed through Aadhaar authentication, the Joint Declaration route applies and the employer's signature is unavoidable.

How many documents

Type of correction	Documents
Minor correction	Aadhaar (mandatory) plus at least one more from the acceptable list — two documents in all
Major correction	Aadhaar plus at least two more from the acceptable list — three documents in all
First name or full name change	Aadhaar, the Gazette notification recording the new name, and a supporting photo identity document carrying the old name

The acceptable list includes passport, birth certificate, driving licence, PAN or e-PAN, voter ID, ration or PDS photo card, school leaving or transfer certificate, board certificate or marksheet with name and photograph, a service photo identity card issued by a government body, PSU or bank, and a bank passbook with name and photograph cross-stamped by a bank official. The Aadhaar card counts towards the total, so a minor correction in practice means Aadhaar plus one more document.

Do not start with the Gazette

A difference between your Aadhaar name and your EPF name does not automatically mean you have changed your name. In most cases one of the two records is simply wrong, and the fix is a profile correction. Establish which record is wrong before you pay for a Gazette notification — the EPFO route will tell you, because it checks your request against the Aadhaar-validated data.

If your employer has closed, or will not sign, the request stalls at the employer step. The practical fixes are: ask the EPFO field office to process the declaration with your own attestation plus the documents, escalate through EPFO's grievance portal, and as a last resort file an RTI application asking for the status of your declaration. Part 19 gives the escalation order.

PART 11

Degrees and board certificates

The part where the answer is sometimes no

This is the part of the chain where people discover that the system is not symmetric. Aadhaar will change your name with a school certificate. A school board will not change your name because Aadhaar says so. The board certificate is treated as a historical record of who you were at seventeen, and the rules for altering it are narrow, time-limited, and enforced.

What the CBSE bye-laws actually say

Rule 69 of the CBSE Examination Bye-laws governs corrections. It creates two separate routes, and mixing them up is why so many applications fail.

Route	What it covers	Conditions
Rule 69.1(i) — change of name or surname	A genuine change of name or surname of the candidate	The change must have been admitted by a court of law and notified in the Government Gazette before the publication of the candidate's result. A Gazette obtained after the result does not satisfy the rule.
Rule 69.1(ii) — spelling and typographical correction	Correction of spelling errors and factual typographical errors in the candidate's name or surname, and in the father's, mother's or guardian's name, to make them consistent with the school record or the list of candidates submitted by the school	Generally available within one year of the declaration of the result, with the application forwarded by the Head of Institution and supported by attested copies of the admission form, the school's admission and withdrawal registers, and the school leaving certificate

Read that first row twice. If you changed your name as an adult and now want your Class 12 certificate to match, the rule asks for a Gazette notification that predates your result — which, by definition, you cannot produce. This is not a loophole that a firm of agents can fix, and any agent who promises otherwise is selling you an application that will be rejected.

> **What actually works for an adult name change on a board certificate**
>
> A court declaration. A civil suit for a declaration of your changed name, decided in your favour, is the instrument the board recognises where the Gazette route is unavailable. It is slower and more expensive than everything else in this book, and it is the honest answer. Take a lawyer's advice before filing, and keep the judgment safe — you will need certified copies for years.

There is one recent development worth knowing if your case is a parent's name rather than your own. In November 2026 the Bombay High Court quashed a CBSE rejection of a request to correct a father's name, holding that a change of the father's name supported by a Gazette notification constituted a factual typographical error correctable under Rule 69.1(ii), rather than a candidate name change under 69.1(i). That reading is useful precedent if your case is exactly that shape. It is a single-judge decision, not a change in the bye-laws, so treat it as an argument to place before the regional office — not a guarantee.

Universities are not the board

Every university has its own statute for correcting a degree certificate, and they vary more than people expect. The common shape is: a written application to the examination or registrar's office, the original certificate surrendered, an affidavit, a Gazette notification or marriage certificate depending on the reason, a fee per certificate, and a processing window that is often tied to the convocation cycle. Two practical notes. First, ask for the correction before you need the degree — a verification request from an employer or a foreign university that hits a name mismatch can freeze an admission or a visa file. Second, ask for a fresh consolidated marksheet at the same time; correcting the degree alone leaves the marksheet inconsistent.

For a professional council registration — medical, dental, nursing, pharmacy, bar council, chartered accountancy, engineering — the council maintains its own register, and a name change has to be recorded there separately, usually with a Gazette notification and an affidavit. Treat the council as its own chain, not as part of the university's.

School records: fix them while your child is enrolled

The school register entry is the document that everything downstream is built on. A correction while the child is studying is a headmaster's signature and a supporting document. A correction after the board certificate is printed is Part 11's first table, with a court in it. If you notice a spelling error in your child's school record this week, fix it this month.

PART 12

The Gazette route

End to end, with the fee, the file and the newspaper

A Gazette notification is the government's public record that you have adopted a new name. It is published by the Department of Publication, Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs, at Civil Lines, Delhi 110054, in Part IV of the Gazette of India — the part reserved for advertisements and notices by private individuals and bodies, as distinct from Parts I to III, which carry government notifications, statutory rules and appointments.

Do you actually need the Central Gazette?

Not always. Name changes can be published in the Gazette of India or in a State Gazette, and which one you need depends on the office you are approaching. The passport rule, for instance, names the State Gazette notification. Aadhaar accepts the Gazette notification for a full name change without specifying which. Where your receiving office is a state authority — a state university, a state RTO, a state revenue office — ask which Gazette it wants before you pay for either.

The fee

The Department of Publication's rate order of 19 September 2023, effective from 14 June 2021, sets the rate for a change-of-name notice in Gazette of India Part IV at ₹1,100 for each adult or major case. The same order sets ₹1,700 for a minor's change of name, ₹1,400 for a public notice, and ₹1,700 for an adoption notice. The Department's own adult guideline still carries an older line stating that ₹1,100 applied from 1 April 2016 to 31 March 2017, which is why you will find pages quoting a range of figures. Pay through the official workflow and treat the amount shown there as the amount due.

Payment goes through the Non-Tax Receipt Portal, BharatKosh, under the Department of Publication. Keep the receipt: it is part of the file, and a file without it is not accepted.

The file, in the order the Department wants it

- ☐ A signed undertaking stating your old name, your new name, your father's or husband's name, your full residential address, and a declaration that the facts are true
- ☐ The original newspaper carrying your advertisement — the whole newspaper, not a clipping
- ☐ The prescribed proforma, typed, in duplicate, signed by you in your old name and by two witnesses
- ☐ A soft copy of the printing matter in MS Word, with your old name typed where the signature would be, on a CD or pen drive
- ☐ Two self-attested passport-size photographs
- ☐ A self-attested photocopy of your photo identity proof
- ☐ A certificate signed by you declaring that the contents of the hard copy and the soft copy are identical
- ☐ A covering request letter, plus the fee receipt from BharatKosh

Documents must be recent

The Department's adult guideline requires that the documents submitted must not be older than one year. A newspaper advertisement you placed eighteen months ago, while waiting to decide, is not a document you can use. Plan the newspaper and the filing as one continuous action.

The newspaper advertisement

For the Central Gazette adult route, the name change must first be advertised in one daily local leading newspaper, and the advertisement must state your father's or husband's name and your residential address. The original newspaper is then forwarded to the Department. Two warnings about the advice you will find online. First, several websites state that two newspapers — one English and one vernacular — are compulsory for the Central Gazette. That is not what the Department's adult guideline says; one daily local leading newspaper is the requirement, and the two-newspaper requirement belongs to the passport route for a major name change. Second, the newspaper cost is separate from the ₹1,100 Gazette fee, and varies with the paper, the city and the size of the advertisement. Ask the paper for the classified rate for a name-change notice and get it in writing.

What happens after you file

The Department scrutinises the file against the applicable guideline. If it is complete, your notice is printed in a weekly issue of the Gazette of India Part IV. There is no guaranteed publication date in the guidelines, and applicants commonly report 30 to 60 days. Once published, download your issue from the official e-Gazette portal at egazette.gov.in — search by Gazette category, then Part IV, then the publication period, open the issue, and search the PDF for your name.

Use the official download

The PDF you download from egazette.gov.in is the legally valid copy and is accepted by government authorities, courts, banks and passport offices. A screenshot from a private website, or a scanned copy forwarded on WhatsApp, is not. Print four copies: one for your file, one for the passport application, one for the bank, and one for whoever asks next.

Filing in person or by post

The file goes to the Controller of Publications, Department of Publication, Civil Lines, Delhi 110054, either in person or by registered post. If you are posting it, send it by registered post with acknowledgement due, keep the receipt, and photograph every page before you seal the envelope. If a page goes missing, that photograph is the difference between a re-submission and a fresh start.

PART 13

Marriage registration

The cheapest document in this book

If you are married and want your spouse's name on your records, the marriage certificate is the instrument that unlocks the whole chain, and registering the marriage is dramatically cheaper and faster than the Gazette route. It is also the route most people skip because they assume the wedding card is enough. It is not: a wedding card is a photograph of a ceremony, and a certificate is a record.

Which Act

Your situation	The usual route
Both parties belong to a religion whose personal law governs marriage — for example a Hindu marriage under the Hindu Marriage Act, 1955	Registration with the Sub-Registrar of Marriages for the district where the marriage took place or where either party resides
A marriage solemnised under the Special Marriage Act, 1954, including inter-faith and court marriages	Notice to the Marriage Officer, a 30-day notice period, then registration with three witnesses

For a Hindu Marriage Act registration you will typically need: the completed application form, the invitation card or a photograph of the ceremony, proof of age for both parties, proof of address for both parties, two or three passport-size photographs each, and three witnesses with their identity proofs. Both parties attend in person. Under the Special Marriage Act the sequence is different — a notice is filed first, there is a 30-day window for objections, and the marriage is then solemnised or registered before the Marriage Officer.

Fees are set by the state and range from a nominal amount to a few thousand rupees; late registration after a long gap may attract an additional fee in some states. Check the fee at the Sub-Registrar's office for your district rather than trusting a number on a website, and ask specifically whether your district has moved to online appointment booking, because many have.

> **Order matters even here**
>
> Register the marriage before you start the Aadhaar update. A marriage certificate with a photograph is a Proof of Identity for UIDAI in its own right, and it is the document that carries the surname you want recorded. Without it, an Annexure D affidavit can still work for Aadhaar, but every other office in the chain will ask you for the certificate anyway.

PART 14

The long tail

Ration card, property, pensions, and the court route

Ration card

A ration card name correction is a state matter, filed at the office of the Food and Civil Supplies department or through the state's e-district portal. The usual documents are the existing card, the updated Aadhaar, the creating document and a photograph. Because the ration card is a family document, a name change for one member can require the head of family to countersign the application. Do it after Aadhaar, and expect the card to be reprinted rather than edited.

Property and land records

A name change on a sale deed is not a correction at all — it is a registration of a subsequent document. Where the name differs only by a spelling or an expanded initial, most sub-registrar offices accept a rectification deed or an affidavit recorded with the registering authority, and some states allow a simple application. Where the name has genuinely changed, the practical route is a registered affidavit plus, in many states, a Gazette notification, and then a rectification deed executed with the other parties. This is the one area in this book where a lawyer is not optional: a defect in a title record surfaces years later, at the worst possible moment, and costs far more than the advice would have.

Pensions and government service records

A Central or State government employee changing a name needs the change recorded in the service book, and the Ministry of Home Affairs has a prescribed route for a deed of change of name for government servants. Ask your establishment section for the current instruction before you draft anything — a service-book entry made without it is a future pension problem. For a pensioner, the pension payment order and the bank's pension account both need updating, and the bank will ask for the same document twice, once for KYC and once for the PPO.

When every route has failed: the court declaration

If an authority refuses a correction that you are entitled to, and escalation has not moved it, the remaining instrument is a civil suit for a declaration — a suit asking a court to declare that you are the person named in the document, or that your name has been changed. Section 34 of the Specific Relief Act, 1963 is the provision most such suits are filed under, and a decree is the document a board, a university or a registrar will accept when every administrative route is closed. It is slow, it costs money, and it is the correct answer in a small number of cases. Take a lawyer's advice before filing, and do not use a court route to shortcut a step you could have completed with a ₹75 Aadhaar update.

PART 15

Templates

Nine drafts, ready to fill

Everything in this part is a model draft, not a statutory form. Where an authority prescribes its own annexure — UIDAI's Annexure B, C, D, E or F, or the Department of Publication's proforma — use the prescribed form and treat these drafts only as a guide to the wording and the facts you must state. Replace every bracket. Do not leave a blank space in a document you are swearing to.

Template 1 — Affidavit for a surname change after marriage

```
AFFIDAVIT

I, [OLD FULL NAME], daughter of [FATHER'S NAME], aged [AGE] years,
resident of [FULL RESIDENTIAL ADDRESS], do hereby solemnly affirm and
state as under:

1. That I was born on [DATE OF BIRTH] and my name was recorded as
   [OLD FULL NAME] in my school records and in my Aadhaar.
2. That I was married to [HUSBAND'S FULL NAME] on [DATE OF MARRIAGE]
   at [PLACE OF MARRIAGE], and the marriage is registered vide
   certificate no. [NUMBER] dated [DATE] issued by the Registrar of
   Marriages, [DISTRICT].
3. That after my marriage I have adopted the surname [NEW SURNAME], and
   my name is now [NEW FULL NAME].
4. That this change of surname is on account of my marriage only, and
   there is no change in my identity.
5. That the name [NEW FULL NAME] and [OLD FULL NAME] refer to one and
   the same person, that is, myself.

I declare that the facts stated above are true to the best of my
knowledge and belief, and nothing material has been concealed.

Place: [PLACE]                      DEPONENT
Date:  [DATE]                       [SIGNATURE]

VERIFICATION
Verified at [PLACE] on this [DAY] day of [MONTH] [YEAR] that the
contents of the above affidavit are true and correct to my knowledge.

                                    DEPONENT

Notarised before: [NOTARY NAME], Notary Public, [PLACE]
```

Template 2 — Affidavit for a spelling correction or data-entry error

```
AFFIDAVIT

I, [NAME AS RECORDED], son/daughter of [FATHER'S NAME], aged [AGE]
years, resident of [ADDRESS], do hereby solemnly affirm and state:

1. That my correct name is [CORRECT SPELLING], as recorded in my
   [DOCUMENT CARRYING THE CORRECT NAME — school leaving certificate /
   board marksheet / birth certificate], bearing no. [NUMBER].
2. That my name was entered as [INCORRECT SPELLING] in my Aadhaar
   [and/or PAN, bank record] due to a data-entry error at the time of
   enrolment, and not on account of any change of name.
3. That the error is a [spelling error / expansion of initials /
   omission of middle name] and the pronunciation of the name is
   unchanged.
4. That [INCORRECT SPELLING] and [CORRECT SPELLING] refer to one and
   the same person, that is, myself.

The facts above are true to the best of my knowledge and belief.

Place: [PLACE]                       DEPONENT
Date:  [DATE]                        [SIGNATURE]

Note: for a UIDAI data-entry error, use UIDAI's prescribed Annexure B
(Annexure C for a minor) and attach this affidavit's substance to it.
```

Template 3 — Affidavit for a full change of name as an adult

```
AFFIDAVIT

I, [OLD FULL NAME], son/daughter of [FATHER'S NAME], aged [AGE] years,
resident of [ADDRESS], do hereby solemnly affirm and state:

1. That I have voluntarily adopted the name [NEW FULL NAME] for all
   purposes, and I renounce the use of my former name [OLD FULL NAME].
2. That the change is not intended to defraud any person, authority,
   creditor or court, and no criminal or civil proceeding is pending
   against me in my former name.
3. That I have published a notice of this change in [NEWSPAPER NAME],
   [EDITION], dated [DATE], and the notice is annexed.
4. That my former name and my adopted name refer to one and the same
   person, that is, myself.
5. That I shall use the name [NEW FULL NAME] consistently in all
   future documents, and shall produce this affidavit and the Gazette
   notification whenever required.

The facts above are true to the best of my knowledge and belief.

Place: [PLACE]                       DEPONENT
Date:  [DATE]                        [SIGNATURE IN OLD NAME]

Witness 1: [NAME, ADDRESS, SIGNATURE]
Witness 2: [NAME, ADDRESS, SIGNATURE]
```

Template 4 — Undertaking for the Department of Publication

```
UNDERTAKING

I, [OLD FULL NAME], son/daughter of [FATHER'S NAME], aged [AGE] years,
resident of [FULL RESIDENTIAL ADDRESS], do hereby undertake as under:

1. That I intend to change my name from [OLD FULL NAME] to
   [NEW FULL NAME] and to have the change published in Part IV of the
   Gazette of India.
2. That my father's / husband's name is [NAME] and my residential
   address is as stated above.
3. That a notice of this change of name has been published in
   [NEWSPAPER NAME], [EDITION], dated [DATE], and the original
   newspaper is enclosed.
4. That the facts stated in this undertaking and in the enclosed
   proforma are true and correct to the best of my knowledge and
   belief, and nothing material has been concealed.
5. That the contents of the hard copy and the soft copy submitted
   with this application are identical.

Place: [PLACE]                        [SIGNATURE IN OLD NAME]
Date:  [DATE]                         [OLD FULL NAME]
                                      [MOBILE NUMBER]
```

Template 5 — Gazette proforma (printing matter)

```
FORMAT OF PRINTING MATTER FOR PUBLICATION IN PART IV OF THE
GAZETTE OF INDIA

                         NOTICE

I, [OLD FULL NAME], son/daughter of [FATHER'S NAME], aged [AGE] years,
resident of [FULL RESIDENTIAL ADDRESS], do hereby notify for the
information of the general public that I have changed my name from
[OLD FULL NAME] to [NEW FULL NAME] with effect from [DATE OF CHANGE].

Henceforth, I shall be known as [NEW FULL NAME] for all purposes.

[OLD FULL NAME]
[FULL RESIDENTIAL ADDRESS]
[DATE]

WITNESSES:
1. [NAME, ADDRESS, SIGNATURE]
2. [NAME, ADDRESS, SIGNATURE]

Note: the Department requires this typed, in duplicate, signed by the
applicant in the old name and by two witnesses, with a soft copy in
MS Word in which the old name is typed where the signature would be.
```

Template 6 — Newspaper advertisement

```
CHANGE OF NAME

I, [OLD FULL NAME], son/daughter of [FATHER'S NAME], resident of
[FULL RESIDENTIAL ADDRESS], have changed my name to [NEW FULL NAME]
with effect from [DATE]. Henceforth I shall be known as
[NEW FULL NAME] for all purposes. Any person having any objection may
write to me at the address above.

[OLD FULL NAME]
[DATE]

Note: publish in one daily local leading newspaper for the Central
Gazette route. Ask the paper for its classified rate for a change-of-
name notice and keep the original newspaper, not a clipping.
```

Template 7 — Request letter to the Department of Publication

```
To
The Controller of Publications,
Department of Publication, Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs,
Civil Lines, Delhi 110054

Subject: Request for publication of a change-of-name notice in Part IV
of the Gazette of India

Sir / Madam,

I, [OLD FULL NAME], son/daughter of [FATHER'S NAME], resident of
[FULL RESIDENTIAL ADDRESS], request publication of the enclosed
change-of-name notice in Part IV of the Gazette of India.

The following documents are enclosed:
1. Signed undertaking
2. Original newspaper dated [DATE] carrying the notice
3. Prescribed proforma in duplicate, signed by me and two witnesses
4. Soft copy of the printing matter in MS Word on a CD / pen drive
5. Two self-attested passport-size photographs
6. Self-attested photocopy of photo identity proof: [DOCUMENT, NUMBER]
7. Certificate that the hard copy and soft copy are identical
8. BharatKosh receipt no. [NUMBER] dated [DATE] for ₹[AMOUNT]

I request that the notice be published at the earliest.

Yours faithfully,
[SIGNATURE IN OLD NAME]
[OLD FULL NAME]
[MOBILE NUMBER]  [EMAIL]
Date: [DATE]   Place: [PLACE]
```

Template 8 — Bank name-change request

```
To
The Branch Manager,
[BANK NAME], [BRANCH], [CITY]

Subject: Request to update my name in account no. [ACCOUNT NUMBER]

Sir / Madam,

I hold [ACCOUNT TYPE] account no. [NUMBER] with your branch in the
name of [OLD NAME]. My name has been changed to [NEW NAME] on account
of [marriage / Gazette notification dated [DATE] / correction of a
spelling error], and the change has been recorded in my Aadhaar
(no. [XXXX]) and PAN ([NUMBER]).

I request you to:
1. Update the account name to [NEW NAME].
2. Update the KYC record and re-seed my Aadhaar to this account.
3. Issue a new cheque book, passbook and debit card in the new name.
4. Note the change against my nomination record.

Enclosures: updated Aadhaar, updated PAN, [marriage certificate /
Gazette notification], two passport-size photographs, self-attested
copies of the above.

Yours faithfully,
[SIGNATURE]   [NEW NAME]
[MOBILE]      [DATE]

Note: a joint account needs the signature of every holder.
```

Template 9 — Covering letter for an EPF joint declaration

```
To
The Employer / Establishment: [ESTABLISHMENT NAME]

Subject: Joint Declaration for correction of name in UAN [UAN NUMBER]

Sir / Madam,

My name is recorded in my EPF member profile as [OLD NAME], whereas my
Aadhaar and PAN record it as [NEW NAME]. The difference is on account
of [marriage / a spelling correction / a change of name notified in
the Gazette of India dated [DATE]].

I have submitted a Joint Declaration through the EPFO Unified Member
Portal on [DATE] with reference no. [NUMBER], and it now awaits your
digital verification.

I request you to verify and approve the declaration at the earliest,
as the mismatch is holding up [a claim / a transfer / a KYC update].

Enclosures: updated Aadhaar, updated PAN, [Gazette notification /
marriage certificate], and [one / two] further identity documents.

Yours faithfully,
[SIGNATURE]   [NEW NAME]   UAN: [NUMBER]
[DATE]
```

PART 16

Fourteen reasons requests get rejected

And the one-line fix for each

#	The rejection	The fix
1	Aadhaar: the document does not carry the requested spelling	Change the request, or change the document first. Aadhaar copies the document, it does not negotiate with you.
2	Aadhaar: an affidavit in a notary's own format instead of the prescribed annexure	Download the current annexure from UIDAI, fill it, and attest it as the annexure requires.
3	Aadhaar: a major change filed without a Gazette notification	It will be rejected. File the Gazette route first (Part 12).
4	Aadhaar: a photograph that does not match, or an address proof that is stale	Book one appointment and fix everything at once — the demographic fee is the same.
5	PAN: a field was typed but its checkbox was not ticked	Re-file, and tick the box. This single omission accounts for a large share of returns.
6	PAN: the requested name does not match Aadhaar	Update Aadhaar first, then re-file PAN in paperless e-KYC mode.
7	PAN: an invitation card used for a change that is not a married woman's name change	Match the document to the row in the Part 6 table. A Gazetted officer's certificate covers the applicant's own name only.
8	Passport: a major name change filed under Tatkaal	Tatkaal is not available for a major name change or a marriage-based change. File under normal processing.
9	Passport: a Gazette notification with no two public documents in the new name	The rule needs both. Fix Aadhaar and PAN first so those two documents exist.
10	Voter ID: more than four corrections in one Form 8	Split into two applications, or drop the non-essential corrections.
11	Driving licence: documents uploaded but no RTO slot booked, where the state requires one	Book the slot after payment; the application is not complete without attendance.
12	EPF: a declaration sent without the employer's digital approval	Chase the employer, and use the covering letter in Template 9. If the employer has closed, escalate (Part 19).
13	CBSE: a Gazette notification obtained after the result was declared	The rule requires it before publication. The remaining route is a court declaration (Part 11).
14	Anywhere: a scan so poor that the officer cannot read the name	Scan at 200 to 300 dpi in colour, straighten the page, and check the file opens before you upload. A rejected upload costs a fortnight.

PART 17

What it actually costs

A budget you can plan against

Item	Government fee	Notes
Aadhaar demographic update (name)	₹75	₹125 if biometrics are also updated; free if the demographic update is done with a biometric update
Aadhaar document update at a centre	₹75	Uploading a PoI or PoA through myAadhaar has been free until 14 June 2027
PAN correction with a physical card	₹107 physical, ₹101 paperless	₹66 to ₹72 for e-PAN only; the fee does not change with the number of fields
Passport re-issue	As shown at payment	Varies by booklet size and processing type; the portal displays it before you pay
Voter ID correction (Form 8)	No fee	Replacement EPIC is issued on approval
Driving licence name change	As shown on Sarathi	State fees vary; a slot may be required
Marriage certificate registration	Set by the state	Ranges from nominal to a few thousand rupees; check at the Sub-Registrar's office
Gazette of India Part IV, change of name (adult)	₹1,100	Rate order of 19 September 2023; pay through BharatKosh
Gazette of India Part IV, change of name (minor)	₹1,700	Same rate order
Newspaper advertisement	Varies	Separate from the Gazette fee; ask the paper for its classified rate in writing
Notary and stamp paper	Varies by state	Usually a modest amount; ask before the notary drafts anything
Agent or middleman	₹0	Every step in this book is doable yourself

A marriage-based surname change, done entirely yourself, typically lands between ₹300 and ₹700 in government fees, plus whatever your state charges for marriage registration if you do not already have a certificate. A full name change through the Gazette adds the ₹1,100 Gazette fee, the newspaper cost, and the notary — budget a few thousand rupees in all, and remember that the newspaper is often the largest single line.

Timelines, realistically

Stage	Typical time
Aadhaar update reflecting	1 to 2 weeks
PAN e-PAN after verification	48 to 72 hours
PAN physical card by post	About 2 weeks
Passport re-issue after appointment	2 to 6 weeks, depending on police verification
Voter ID correction	2 to 4 weeks

Stage	Typical time
Driving licence smart card	2 to 4 weeks
Gazette publication	30 to 60 days commonly reported; no guaranteed date
Board or university certificate correction	1 to 6 months, and sometimes a convocation cycle

PART 18

The 30-day plan

What to do on which day

Days	Do this
Day 1	Complete the two-minute audit in Part 3. Photograph every identity document you own. Identify your creating document.
Day 2	If you need a marriage certificate, book the Sub-Registrar appointment. If you need a Gazette, order the newspaper advertisement and download the Department's proforma.
Day 3	Book the Aadhaar Seva Kendra slot. Download the correct annexure for your category and get it attested.
Day 4	Attend the Aadhaar appointment with originals. Keep the URN.
Day 5 to 10	Draft the PAN CR-01. Assemble passport documents. Do not file PAN yet.
Day 10 to 14	Aadhaar reflects. Download a fresh e-Aadhaar. File PAN in paperless e-KYC mode and pay.
Day 14 to 18	File voter ID Form 8. File the driving licence change on Sarathi and book the RTO slot if required.
Day 18 to 21	File the passport re-issue with the marriage certificate or Annexure J, or with the Gazette plus two public documents. Take the earliest appointment.
Day 21 to 24	One bank visit: name change, re-KYC, Aadhaar re-seeding, nomination review, new cheque book. Tell payroll the same day.
Day 24 to 27	Credit card reissue, insurer endorsements, RTA and demat updates, SIM re-verification. Photograph every acknowledgement.
Day 27 to 30	Submit the EPF joint declaration and send Template 9 to your employer. Open the degree or board file if you need it — and if it is a name change rather than a typo, read Part 11 again before you spend anything.
Day 30	Run the master checklist in Part 21. Anything unticked becomes next month's first task.

The one-day version

If you only have one free day: audit (30 minutes), Aadhaar appointment (2 hours), PAN filing (40 minutes), voter ID and driving licence (30 minutes), bank visit (45 minutes). Everything else can wait a week without breaking the chain.

PART 19

When an office says no

The escalation ladder, in order

Escalation works when it is specific, documented and polite. Before you escalate, assemble the file: the application reference number, the date of submission, the rejection reason in writing or a screenshot, the documents you submitted, and the name of the officer you spoke to. Without those five things, an escalation is a complaint. With them, it is a case.

1. The written request. Ask the office, in writing or by email, for the specific provision under which your request was rejected. Many refusals are a counter clerk's habit, and a written query ends them.
2. The department's own grievance portal. UIDAI, the Passport Seva programme, the Election Commission, EPFO and almost every state transport department run one. Attach the file and quote the reference number.
3. CPGRAMS. The Centralised Public Grievance Redress and Monitoring System reaches every Central ministry, including the Department of Publication and UIDAI. Escalate there if the department's own portal has not answered within a reasonable time.
4. The RBI's complaint route, for a bank. If a branch refuses a name change on an account with valid documents, a written complaint to the bank's nodal officer, followed by the RBI Ombudsman, moves it.
5. RTI. A Right to Information application asking for the status of your application, the reasons for delay, and the file notings is slow but effective, because it creates a written record that someone must answer.
6. The court declaration. Part 14. The last resort, and the right one in a small number of cases.

Two things not to do

Do not pay an agent to "handle" a rejection before you know the reason — most rejections are a document mismatch, and an agent cannot change your documents any more than you can. And do not file the same application again unchanged. A second identical submission produces a second identical rejection and costs you another fortnight.

PART 20

Twenty questions people actually ask

Short answers, no hedging

About the rules

1. Do I need a Gazette notification to take my husband's surname? No. A marriage certificate is enough for Aadhaar, PAN, the passport and the bank. The Gazette is for a genuinely new name.

2. I changed my surname years ago and never updated anything. Is it harder now? No, but the documents are older. Aadhaar still treats it as a marriage-based surname change, and the same annexure applies. Start with the marriage certificate.

3. Does Aadhaar accept a marriage certificate without a photograph? It is accepted, but if the certificate carries no photograph you must also submit a supporting PoI that has your old name and a photograph.

4. Can I change my name in Aadhaar twice? Aadhaar limits how often key fields can be updated, and name updates are counted. Assume you get one clean change and make it the right one.

5. Is the Gazette of India accepted everywhere? Mostly, but the passport rule names the State Gazette notification, and state authorities may want a State Gazette. Ask the receiving office before you pay.

6. Can I use a deed poll instead of a Gazette? Some offices accept a deed of change of name, and the Ministry of Home Affairs prescribes a deed route for government servants. Aadhaar's major-change rule asks for a Gazette notification. Do not assume a deed will substitute.

About the paperwork

7. What is Annexure J and do I need a notary? It is a joint photo declaration signed by both spouses, used by the passport office in place of a marriage certificate. Since the Passport Rules were amended on 23 December 2016, it needs no notarisation, no stamp paper and no magistrate.

8. My marriage certificate has my maiden name. Can I still use it? Yes. It is the proof of the marriage, not of the new name; the surname change follows from it.

9. What if my spouse's name is spelled differently on the certificate? Fix that at the Sub-Registrar's office first. A certificate with two inconsistent spellings invites a query at every counter downstream.

10. Do I need an affidavit for a spelling correction? For Aadhaar, only if it is a data-entry error (Annexure B). For a minor spelling change, a PoI is enough. For PAN, a document carrying the correct spelling is usually enough.

11. Where do I get the UIDAI annexures? From UIDAI's own site, with your Aadhaar Kendra as a check. Do not use a version copied from a private blog — formats are revised.

12. How recent must documents be for the Gazette file? The Department's adult guideline says documents must not be older than one year.

About the money and the time

13. What is the total cost of a marriage surname change? Usually ₹300 to ₹700 in government fees if you already hold a marriage certificate, plus state registration fees if you do not.

14. Is it cheaper to use an agent? No. Agents charge for the same forms you can file, and the government fee does not change. They are useful only when you cannot attend a centre in person.

15. How long until everything matches? Three to five weeks for a marriage surname change, if you run the offices in parallel as Part 18 sets out.

16. Can I travel while my passport is being re-issued? Yes, but you must surrender the old booklet at the appointment. Plan travel around the appointment, not around the delivery.

About the awkward cases

17. I have only one name. What do I do? Ask the Passport Seva Kendra before filing. The options are expanding the name, recording it in both fields where accepted, or a formal change. Do not guess, because the fee is not refundable.

18. My degree has the wrong name and I graduated ten years ago. Is it hopeless? Not hopeless, but it is the hardest item in this book. Read Part 11's two rules: a spelling or typographical correction within the board's window, or a court declaration for a change of name. Universities set their own statutes; ask the registrar in writing.

19. My child's Aadhaar name is wrong. What is the route? An Annexure C affidavit with a PoI, or a PoR or Head of Family based update for a child under 18. Fix the school register entry first, because that is the document everything else copies.

20. Will changing my name affect my existing loans, investments or policies? The contracts stay valid; the records need updating. The risk is at claim or redemption time, when a name mismatch becomes a query. Work through Part 9 in one sweep and keep the acknowledgements.

PART 21

The master checklist

Print this page

Before you pay anything

☐ I know which of the eight cases in Part 3 is mine

☐ I know which document is my creating document

☐ I have photographed every identity document I own

☐ I have compared name, initials, father's or husband's name and date of birth across all of them

☐ I know whether my case is minor, a data-entry error, or major

Aadhaar

☐ Correct annexure downloaded (B, C, D, E or F) and attested

☐ Appointment booked, or online update route chosen

- ☐ Original and photocopy of the creating document carried
- ☐ Second PoI carried as backup
- ☐ Update request number (URN) saved
- ☐ Fresh e-Aadhaar downloaded after the update reflected

PAN

- ☐ Aadhaar already shows the new name
- ☐ PAN CR-01 filed on Protean or UTIITSL
- ☐ Every changed field has its checkbox ticked
- ☐ Paperless e-KYC with Aadhaar OTP completed
- ☐ 15-digit acknowledgement number saved
- ☐ e-PAN received and checked against Aadhaar

Passport, voter ID, driving licence

- ☐ Re-issue filed under change in existing personal particulars
- ☐ Marriage certificate or signed Annexure J attached
- ☐ For a major change: Gazette notification plus two public documents in the new name
- ☐ Old passport carried to the appointment in original
- ☐ Voter ID Form 8 filed, maximum four corrections
- ☐ Driving licence change filed on Sarathi and the RTO slot booked if required

The copies

- ☐ Bank: name, KYC, Aadhaar re-seeding, nomination, new cheque book
- ☐ Payroll informed on the same day
- ☐ Credit card reissued; auto-debits re-registered
- ☐ Health, term and motor policies endorsed
- ☐ Mutual fund folios and demat updated; CKYC checked
- ☐ SIM re-verified at a store
- ☐ Subsidy and DBT mapping re-checked

The slow items

- ☐ EPF joint declaration submitted and employer approval obtained
- ☐ School register entry corrected if the child is still enrolled
- ☐ Board or university application filed, with the right rule cited
- ☐ Professional council register updated
- ☐ Ration card, property records and pension records addressed
- ☐ Every acknowledgement photographed and filed in one folder

APPENDIX

Where every rule in this book comes from

Official sources, checked on 11 November 2026

This book is built on primary sources, not on other people's guides. If an office disputes a step, quote the source. The pages below were checked on 11 November 2026; where a page carries a downloadable guideline or circular, download it and keep your own copy, because government sites reorganise themselves without notice.

Subject	Source
Aadhaar name-update categories, annexures and verification	UIDAI circular issuing the revised Standard Operating Procedure for name updates, dated 18 September 2026, superseding the SOP of 28 October 2021
Aadhaar acceptable documents for a name update	UIDAI, List of Acceptable Supporting Documents for Verification, October 2026 revision
Aadhaar fees and service channels	UIDAI, Aadhaar Enrolment and Update charges; UIDAI Aadhaar Seva Kendra page and bookappointment.uidai.gov.in
Aadhaar document-update fee waiver	UIDAI, Aadhaar Enrolment and Update charges, document update through myAadhaar free until 14 June 2027
PAN correction form and procedure	Protean eGov Technologies PAN services portal; UTIITSL; Income Tax Department, Apply for PAN
PAN name-change documents	Income Tax Department, form for changes in PAN data, and Rule 114(4) of the Income-tax Rules
PAN correction fees	Protean PAN change-request guidelines, fee table, checked November 2026
Passport name-change documents	Passport Seva, documents required for re-issue, including Annexure J; Passport Seva Application Form Instruction Booklet V3.0, Table 2 and the document list
Passport name-change rule text	Passport (Amendment) Rules, 2016, notified 23 December 2016
Voter ID correction	Election Commission of India, Form 8, and the Citizen Service Portal at voters.eci.gov.in
Driving licence name change	Parivahan Sarathi, services on driving licence; Form 2 under the Central Motor Vehicles Rules
Gazette change of name	Department of Publication, Guidelines for Change of Name — Adult/Major; Guidelines for Notification of Public Notice; list of acceptable documents as proof of old name and address
Gazette fees	Department of Publication, Office Order revising rates of publication of advertisements and notices in the Gazette of India and Delhi Gazette, dated 19 September 2023
Gazette payment route	Department of Publication, payment procedure through BharatKosh (NTRP)
Gazette download	e-Gazette portal, egazette.gov.in
EPF name correction	EPFO Unified Member Portal, Joint Declaration facility; EPFO joint declaration document list and the January 2025 simplification of member-profile correction

Subject	Source
CBSE corrections	CBSE Examination Bye-laws, Rule 69.1, and CBSE's revised rules for correction of name and date of birth
Marriage registration	Hindu Marriage Act, 1955, and the Special Marriage Act, 1954, as administered by the Sub-Registrar of Marriages
Court declaration	Specific Relief Act, 1963, Section 34

Two notes on using this appendix. First, a departmental guideline is not a statute: it can be revised by an office order, and UIDAI's September 2026 circular is itself an example of a process being replaced wholesale. If a counter quotes a rule that contradicts this book, ask for the circular number and check whether it is newer than the sources above. Second, state-level processes — ration cards, property registration, university statutes, RTO document lists — genuinely differ, and no book can replace one phone call to your district office. This book tells you what to ask and in what order; the last mile is always local.

One name, every record

You now have the order. Start with the document that is allowed to create the name, then Aadhaar, then PAN, then everything that copies from them. Print the checklist, work the calendar, and photograph every acknowledgement. That is the whole method — and it is the reason this takes weeks instead of years.